The query has two parts: a `script` and an `upsert` block. The `script` part is where we update the field on an existing document, while the `upsert` block consists of the new `movie` document information.

Listing 5.31 Upsert block example

```
POST movies/_update/5
{
  "script": {
    "source": "ctx._source.gross_earnings = '357.1m'"
  },
  "upsert": {
    "title":"Top Gun",
    "gross_earnings":"357.5m"
  }
}
```

When we execute this query, we expect the script to run and update the `gross_earnings` field on a document with ID 5 (if the document is available). What happens if that document is not in our index? Well, that's where the `upsert` block comes into play.

The second part of the JSON request is interesting: the `upsert` block consists of fields constituting a new document. Because there is no document with that ID in the store, the `upsert` block creates a new document with the specified fields. So, an upsert action provides us with the facility of either updating an existing document or creating a new one if it's the first time we index it.

If we run the same query a second time, the `script` part is executed and changes the field `gross_earnings` to `357.1m` (from `357.5m` in the original document). This happens because the document already exists.

5.4.6 Updates as upserts

In section 5.4.2, we looked at partially updating a document using the `doc` object via the `_update` API. In the following listing, we update a movie with an additional field, `runtime_in_minutes`. If document 11 exists, this field is updated as expected; otherwise, an error is thrown, stating that the document does not exist.

Listing 5.32 Updating a nonexistent field (which will throw an error)

```
POST movies/_update/11
{
  "doc": {
    "runtime_in_minutes":110
  }
}
```

To avoid errors—maybe we want to create a new document if the document does not exist—we can use a `doc_as_upsert` flag. Setting this flag to `true` allows the contents of the `doc` object to be stored as a new document if the document (ID = 11) doesn't exist.